Day of the Overseas Indian.) Veer Savarkar, after travelling to the UK for law studies, sought asylum in France before his arrest by British authorities. [77] B.R. Ambedkar was educated in the United States in addition to the UK, which in turn influenced his worldview. Somewhat more unusually, the Indian communist M.N. Roy founded what became the Mexican Communist Party before returning to India.

Beyond economic and cultural exchanges, there were direct consequences of British colonialism for India's role in international politics and security. At various points in time, Burma, Sri Lanka, Malaya (including Singapore), Yemen, Somaliland, the Trucial States (United Arab Emirates), Bahrain, Oman, Kuwait, and Qatar were governed or administered from today's India, although sometimes only for brief periods or indirectly. Meanwhile, the British Indian Army was deployed widely overseas. In China, Indian soldiers were involved in the sack of the Old Summer Palace outside Beijing in 1860 during the Second Opium War and in the suppression of the Boxer Rebellion in 1900–1901. (Both episodes are still remembered as national humiliations in China today. [78]) In the nineteenth century, Indian forces were deployed frequently in North and East Africa and in India's extended neighbourhood: from Burma to Ceylon and Malaya. In Tibet, Indian forces took part in the Younghusband Expedition in 1903–04 to Lhasa meant to extend Britain's economic influence across the Himalayas and pre-empt Russian advances as part of the 'Great Game'. [79]

During World War I, the Indian Army saw action in Mesopotamia, Africa, Gallipoli, and the Western front in Europe. Over 70,000 Indian soldiers perished. Troops from the princely states contributed in significant ways to, among other things, the capture of Haifa (now in Israel), an occasion commemorated in New Delhi's Teen Murti Memorial. During World War II, a volunteer Indian force of 2,500,000 was raised, trained, and deployed. It served in Singapore, Burma, Iraq, Iran, North Africa, and Italy, and suffered nearly 90,000 fatalities. In both World Wars, Indian revenues contributed significantly to the British-led war effort, including from the princely states. [80]